

Assessment 1 – Instructions



The Purpose

There are hundreds of different weight loss methods found on the internet. Some have scientific merit and are safe to use while others are completely bogus and could potentially kill you. Understanding how a weight-loss method works scientifically can help you determine if it is something you should try. This assessment requires you to evaluate and critique a weight-loss method to determine if you would recommend it to someone. This assessment also helps you to develop critical thinking and written and visual communication skills.

The Task

Your friend Amy wants to lose weight quickly and has decided to use a weight-loss drug. She thinks the weight loss drug **Lorcaserin** would be the best option for her, but she is having trouble understanding how this drug works and how it leads to weight loss. Since you have been learning about weight loss and metabolism in this course, she has decided to ask you for some advice. You are required to produce a written document for Amy using [the template provided](#) to answer some specific questions she has for you.

Below are some personal statistics about Amy you can refer to when advising Amy.

- **Age:** 23
- **Weight:** 86 kg
- **Height:** 1.72 m
- **Medical History:** No known conditions

Expectations and Marking Criteria

Generative AI Use: You may use generative AI to complete this assessment task in any way you see fit. The only section you cannot use AI for is the 'Assessment Completion Process' section below which is a reflection section that must be written in your own words.

The written document must cover all the following aspects. Total marks available is 50.

Description of the drug and how it works (13 marks)

- Describe the drug: when was it discovered, who should use the drug and at what dosage (3 marks)
- Using an appropriate diagram describe the mechanism of action of this drug (5 marks)
- Explain how this mechanism of action leads to weight loss. You must refer to the content from lectures to answer this section (5 marks)

Scientific Studies (8 marks)

- Include results of two different scientific studies done to measure the effectiveness of the drug. You must provide sufficient details about the study to understand the study design, methods, findings and what the results mean. The document must also contain screencaps of the journal articles you used as seen below. (8 marks)



Critique of the weight loss drug (7 marks)

- Provide a critique of the weight loss method that is backed up by evidence from your research. You should focus on the following:
 - Potential general side effects associated with the drug? (1 mark)
 - Does it lead to or eliminate the risk of specific diseases? (2 marks)
 - Does the drug allow you to get all the necessary nutrients. (2 marks)
 - sustainability of using the drug long term and whether the weight loss will remain once you stop taking the drug? (2 marks)

Conclusion (5 marks)

- Would you recommend Amy use this drug? Give reasons as to why you came to this conclusion. You should also use Amy's stats to help support your conclusion (5 marks)

Creative Appeal of the written document (5 marks)

- You will be rewarded for creativity and how visually appealing the slides are.
- Your critique should present information succinctly.
- Any images used other than decorative ones must have a figure legend along with a reference to the original image.
- The information you present on the slides must be in your own words. You cannot copy information directly from websites or other online sources.

References (2 marks)

You should include a full reference list done in any style.

- Must include in-text references.
- A minimum of 6 references is required.
- These references are not expected to be just scientific journal articles, but they must be from reputable sources, for example, articles published in [The Conversation](#) or [Harvard Health](#). Other reliable sources include [Learn.Genetics](#), articles published on university or research institute websites (will have .edu in the web address), such as [UNSW Newsroom](#), or government websites (will have .gov in the web address).

Assessment Completion Process (10 marks)

There are no right or wrong answers for this section. You are meant to honestly reflect on your learning process. **This section must be written in your own words without the help of AI.** You will get the full 10 marks as long as you have answered the bullet points below in sufficient detail.

- **Answer the following questions if you used AI to complete this assessment task:**
 - Why did you decide to use AI to complete this assessment task?
 - What types of AI tools did you use to complete this assessment and how were they used?
 - Can you describe a specific instance where an AI tool significantly helped you understand a concept when completing this assessment. You can include screen captures of the AI prompts and outputs that were used to support your answer.
 - Explain how confident you feel about the accuracy of the information that was provided by AI and how you handle that?
 - What is your biggest concern about relying on AI tools to complete assessment tasks and why?
 - How can educators better support you in using AI tools effectively for your learning?
 - If a tutor were to quiz you on the content of this assessment task in person how confident are you in being able to answer their questions. Would the confidence level change if you did not use AI to complete the assessment?
- **Answer the following questions if you did not use any AI to complete this assessment task:**
 - Why did you decide not to use AI to complete this assessment task?
 - What was your process for researching and completing this assessment task?
 - Have you ever used AI to complete assessment tasks? If so, which tools were the most helpful and why?
 - Do you worry that relying on AI tools now might negatively impact your ability to learn independently in the future?
 - How can educators better support you in using AI tools effectively for your learning?
 - If a tutor were to quiz you on the content of this assessment task in person how confident are you in being able to answer their questions. Would the confidence level change if you used AI to complete the assessment?

You will also be tested on this weight loss drug in the Exam in Week 9.

Timeline

Here is a suggested timeline for the Assessment.

- **Week 1** – Read the Assessment Instructions.
- **Week 2** – Start researching the weight-loss method.
- **Week 3** – Sort the information into the relevant sections.
- **Week 4** – Answer the questions on the provided template and finalise the reference list.
- **Week 5** – Make the slides visually appealing and submit the assessment task.